ARIPIPRAZOLE

Metabolically neutral

Akathisia, impulse control

CHEMICAL NAME 7-[4-[4-(2,3-dichlorophenyl)piperazin-1-yl]butoxy]-3,4-dihydroquinolin-2(1H)-one

CLASS Second-generation antipsychotic — dopamine D2 partial agonist

TRADE NAMES Abilify · Abilify Maintena (depot) · Aripiprex

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Schizophrenia (adults, adolescents ≥15 yr).
- Bipolar mania and maintenance.
- Adjunct in major depression.
- Irritability in autism; Tourette's syndrome (children).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily with or without food.
- **IM** short-acting (agitation) or monthly depot (Maintena — oral overlap 14 days).

DOSAGES

- **Schizophrenia:** 10–15 mg once daily; max 30 mg.
- **Mania:** 15 mg daily.
- **Depression adjunct:** 2–5 mg, up to 15 mg.
- **Depot:** 400 mg monthly.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 3–5 h. Bioavailability 87%.
- Metabolised by CYP2D6 and 3A4 to active dehydro-aripiprazole.
- **t½:** 75 h (metabolite 94 h).

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Monitor for akathisia, insomnia, impulsive behaviours.
- Mental-state monitoring.
- Lower metabolic risk but still monitor weight/glucose.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- **Partial agonist at D2 and 5-HT1A**, antagonist at **5-HT2A**; "dopamine stabiliser".
- Little prolactin elevation, weight gain or sedation.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Akathisia (restlessness), insomnia.
- Nausea, headache, anxiety.
- Dizziness.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Impulse-control disorders (gambling, binge eating, hypersexuality).
- NMS; tardive dyskinesia (low).
- Suicidality (young); stroke in elderly with dementia.
- Hypotension, seizures (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **CYP2D6 inhibitors (fluoxetine, paroxetine) / CYP3A4 inhibitors:** halve dose.
- **Carbamazepine:** double dose.
- **Alcohol:** ↑ CNS effects.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Report restlessness or urges you cannot control (gambling, spending, eating).
- May cause insomnia; take in the morning if so.
- Do not stop suddenly.

KEY POINTS

- D2 partial agonist — dopamine stabiliser.
- Akathisia; impulse-control disorders.
- 10–15 mg daily.
- Low weight gain and prolactin.